DELHI.

Sir,

I was working as Inspector General (Prisons) from 1 May 1993 to 5 May 1995. I stood 'relieved' on 5 May 1995 vide your order No. F. 5/3/95-Home (P) Estt., Govt. of Delhi dated 3 May 1995. I thereafter handed over charge on same day afternoon.

The news report of 21 April 1995, *Indian Express*, page 1 under caption 'Shift out Kiran Bedi, Dave tells ministry', reveals the allegations on the basis of which Central Govt. appears to have been approached for my transfer out of the Tihar Jail posting. This was subsequently elaborated and apparently clarified in a news item of *Punjab Kesri* of 22 April 1995 page 5. In all fairness, I requested for confirmation of these news items as well as time from the Hon'ble Lt. Governor vide my letter No. PA/IG(P)/95/ 179, dated 21 April 1995 so as to explain matters in reference to the allegations made which had now become apparently 'too' public. I also wrote to the Hon'ble Prisons Minister (Ref. news item in *Punjab Kesri*). I have not so far been favoured with the reply from either the Hon'ble Lt. Governor or Hon'ble Minister for Jails.

I only wish to reiterate that as an officer of Indian Police Service, I can have no objections to a transfer … However, in my case the manner of my transfer has tended to become one of my 'public trial' which regretfully became extremely punitive in nature. I submit that as a service officer I owe it to myself and my family to protect my reputation and save myself from the adverse effects it would have on my family and our social position. I submit that in the present case I was given no opportunity to explain my conduct to my superiors prior to or after the mind was made up. It would appear, therefore, that the decision for my transfer was made without consideration of my explanation and of my conduct but on a prima facie impression of my work given by some other individuals. I hope you will be kind enough to devise measures to redeem adverse effects which I have suffered as a consequence of the above events.

Yours faithfully,

KIRAN BEDI
Addl. Commissioner of Police
Planning & Implementation
26 May 1995

Till date Kiran has not received a reply to this letter either.

The Home Department went further in stating that 'new practices in the management of the jail (were being followed) which do not seem to be strictly in accordance with the provisions of the Jail Manual/Prisons Act'. These practices, it claimed, were 'journalists being allowed to take interviews and photographs of inmates, preparation of television features in jail and allowing up to four hundred visitors at a time on *Raksha Bandhan* without search'. As the media had easy access to the jail activities, there was plenty of footage in the national and international channels. Interestingly, however, the Delhi Administration officials claimed that they came to know about all these so-called 'irregularities' only through a book written by a jail superintendent and published in early 1995. Anyway, when they claimed that the changes taking place in Tihar 'do not seem to be strictly in accordance with the provisions' (operative words being 'seem' and 'strictly') it was quite obvious